# Locking System



Category: **Safety & PPE** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 20 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Locking systems

## What it is used for

A locking system secures equipment, doors, storage areas, or access points against unauthorised use. Operate the specific lock according to its design and the site's access-control procedure.

## How to use

1. Identify the lock type and confirm you are authorised to operate it.
2. Inspect the lock, key, latch, and mounting for damage.
3. Check that the door, cover, or equipment is in the correct position before locking.
4. Engage the lock using the specified key, code, or locking control.
5. Verify that the lock is fully engaged and the secured item cannot open unintentionally.
6. For authorised access, release the lock using the approved method.
7. Record access or lock status when required by site procedure.
8. Return keys or access devices to their designated secure location.

## ⚠ Safety

- Never force a jammed lock or bypass access controls without authorisation.
- Keep keys and access codes restricted to authorised users.
- Follow lockout and tagout procedures when locking equipment for maintenance.
- Report damaged locks or signs of tampering promptly.

## Care & storage

- Keep locks clean and maintain them using the manufacturer's recommended method.
- Inspect keys, latches, and mounting points regularly and replace defective parts.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*